SMARTBRIDGE
Let's Bridge the Gap

Business Question and Story Report

Date	21 August 2026
Project Name	AI Career Pulse: Decoding the Job Market

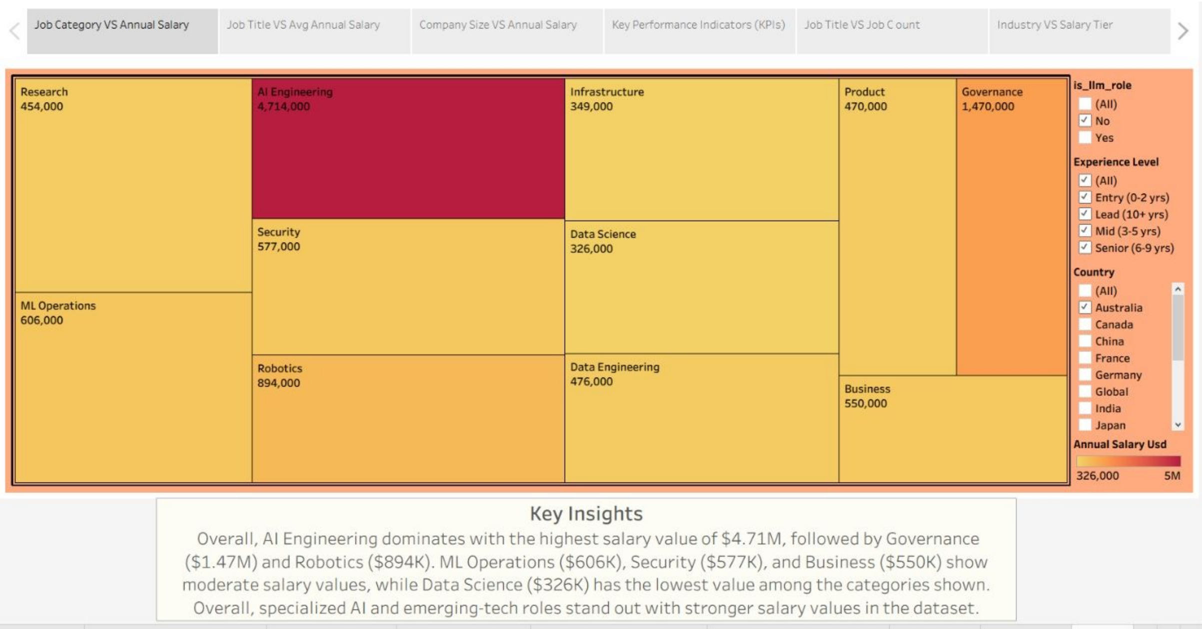
Introduction The AI job market is evolving at a rapid pace, with hiring demand, compensation, and required skill sets shifting across industries, company sizes, and experience levels. This project uses Tableau to explore and visualize these shifts in a clear and interactive way. The analysis focuses on understanding how annual salaries vary across AI job categories and job titles, identifying which industries and company sizes offer the strongest compensation, tracking the growth of AI job postings over time, and examining how hiring demand is distributed across different experience levels.

Visualisation Used in Tableau

No.	Business Question	Visualisation	Purpose	Insight
1	How does the average annual salary compare across the different AI job categories?	Tree Map	To compare salary contribution across AI job categories.	AI Engineering stands out with the highest salary value at $4.71M, well ahead of Governance ($1.47M) and Robotics ($894K). ML Operations, Security, and Business fall in a moderate range of $550K–$606K, while Data Science records the lowest value at $326K — showing that specialised, emerging-tech roles command a disproportionately larger share of salary value.
2	Which specific AI job titles command the highest average annual salaries?	Bar Chart	To compare average annual salaries across individual AI job titles.	AI Security Engineer leads with an average annual salary of $141K, closely followed by AI Product Manager at $140K. Data Engineer (AI) and Robotics Engineer (AI) average $130K and $125K respectively, while AI Business Analyst trails the group at $98K — suggesting hands-on technical and security-focused roles are valued slightly more than business-facing ones.
3	How does annual salary value vary across different company sizes?	Horizontal Bar Chart	To compare total salary value across company-size segments.	Enterprise companies (5000+) post the highest salary value at $3.53M, followed by Mid-size firms (501–5000) at $2.96M and Big Tech/FAANG+ at $2.89M. Startups sit at $2.76M, while SMEs (51–500) show the lowest figure at $2.53M — larger, established organisations currently drive the bulk of AI salary spend.
4	What do the key indicators reveal about pay levels and entry requirements in the AI job market?	KPI Cards	To summarise headline compensation and experience benchmarks for AI roles.	The average annual salary across AI roles stands at a strong $188K, and even the average minimum salary offered is a competitive $131K. The average minimum experience required is just 2 years, pointing to a market that pays well while remaining relatively accessible to early-career talent.

No.	Business Question	Visualisation	Purpose	Insight
5	Which AI job titles have the largest number of open postings?	Horizontal Bar Chart	To compare posting volume across AI job titles.	LLM Engineer is the most in-demand title with 7 postings, ahead of AI Business Analyst, AI Compliance Manager, and Robotics Engineer (AI), each with 5. Core roles such as AI Engineer, Deep Learning Engineer, ML Engineer, and Multimodal AI Engineer show steady demand at 4 postings each, while AI Infrastructure Engineer, Generative AI Engineer, NLP Engineer, and Senior Data Scientist remain smaller, emerging categories with 2 postings each.
6	How do salary tiers differ across industries hiring for AI roles?	Segmented Bar Chart	To compare the distribution of salary tiers across industries.	Government roles sit exclusively in the Upper-Mid tier ($150K–$200K), making it the highest-paying sector shown. Healthcare shows the most balanced spread, split evenly between Entry (under $100K) and Mid ($100K–$150K) postings, while Retail roles fall consistently in the Mid tier — Government emerges as the premium sector and Healthcare as the most active.
7	How has the volume of AI job postings changed year-over-year?	Year-based Bar Chart	To track job-posting activity across years.	AI job postings grew from 1 in 2025 to 3 in 2026 — a threefold increase that, while based on an early sample, signals accelerating hiring momentum and a rapidly expanding AI job market.
8	How is hiring demand distributed across AI job categories and experience levels?	Heat Map	To compare hiring concentration across job categories by experience level.	Demand for AI Engineering talent is heavily concentrated at the Lead (10+ yrs) level, the single highest category-experience combination, with a secondary cluster at Mid (3–5 yrs). Data Science and Data Engineering show a more even spread across Senior and Lead levels, while Robotics postings appear only at Entry (0–2 yrs) — overall, hiring leans toward experienced talent, especially for AI Engineering roles.

<u>Story:</u> Exploring the AI Career Opportunity Landscape



Story Conclusion Final Insight

Bringing salary, demand, industry, company size, timing, and experience level together paints a fuller picture of where AI career opportunities are concentrated. AI Engineering emerges as the strongest overall theme — it carries the highest salary contribution and dominates senior- and lead-level hiring, anchoring the category most consistently rewarded across the dataset. Compensation runs strongest at large, established organisations and within Government and Healthcare-linked postings, while overall hiring volume continues to climb year-over-year. Roles such as LLM Engineer stand out as the most sought-after, and the market as a whole leans toward experienced talent, particularly for AI Engineering positions. These conclusions are drawn strictly from the cleaned and validated dataset used in this analysis.

Tableau Public Story Link:

https://public.tableau.com/views/AI-Career-Pulse-Decoding-Job-MarketStory1/Story1?:language=en-US&:sid=&:redirect=auth&:display_count=n&:origin=viz_share_link